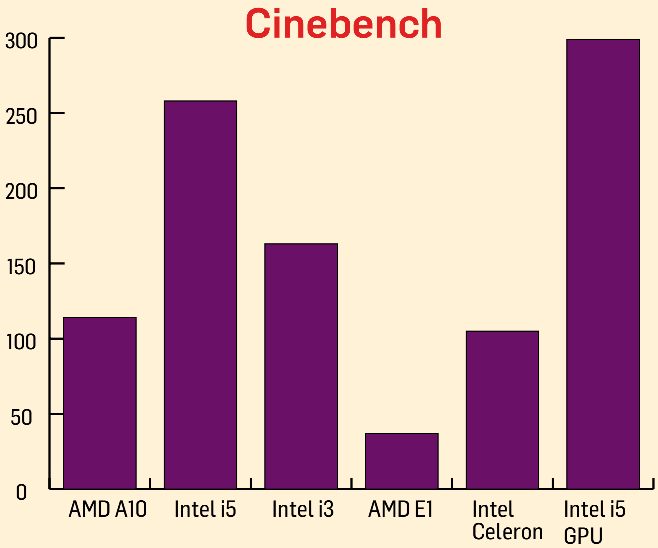
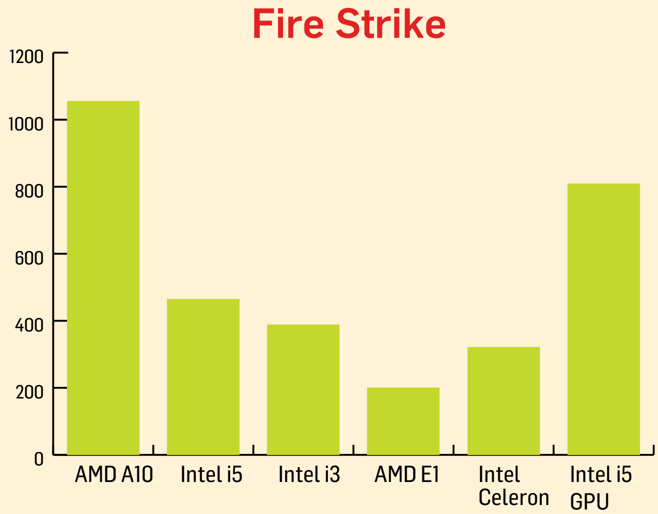
CPU GUIDE

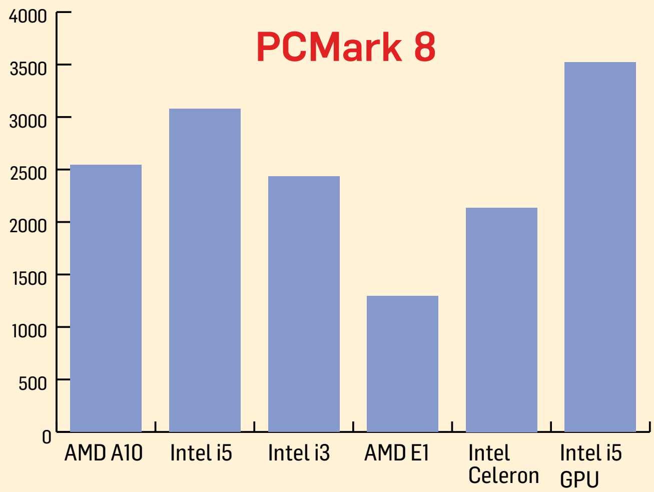
We've got nine very different laptops powered by six different CPU+GPU combos. Picking the right one can be quite a headache and to ease that headache, we've sorted out the salient information that you will need to make a buying decision.



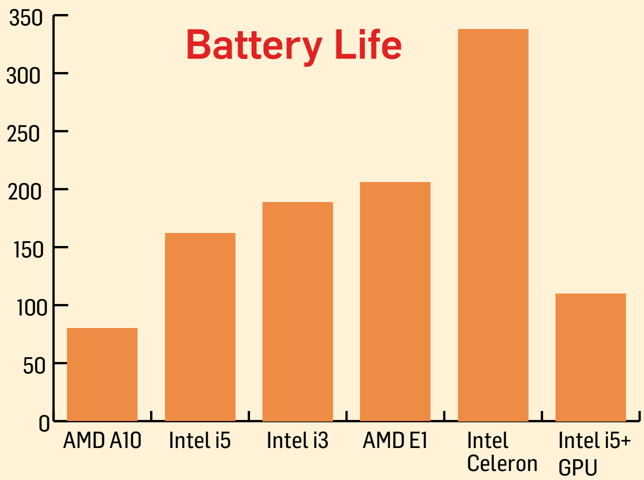
PROCESSING POWER:
If it's raw processing power that you want (for programming, Premiere Pro, etc.), it's the Intel Core i5 CPU that you need. As can be seen from the graph, even AMD's fancy A10 APU can only manage the processing power of Intel's low-end Celeron CPU.



GAMING:
If it's games that you want to play, the graphical prowess of the APU is not in question. As you can see, the Intel Core i5+720M combo is also a little behind. That said, do note that the extra processing power of the Core i5 will be more useful to you than the APU's GPU power.



OVERALL PERFORMANCE:
For all practical purposes, PCMark8 is an excellent indicator of overall system performance. As you can see, a better CPU is more advantageous than a GPU. Note that the Intel i3 is not that far behind the Core i5.



BATTERY LIFE:
The lower end Celeron takes the lead, and by a huge margin. As you can see, the APUs are extremely power hungry and this is due to their powerful on-board GPUs.

As you can see, the choice is still not an easy one, but if you're clear about what you want to do with your system, the choice is obvious. Our recommendations are as follows:

- Basic PC usage and great battery life: Intel Celeron series
- A reasonable all-rounder PC: AMD A10 or Intel Core i5 based laptop depending on budget
- Gaming: Intel i3 or i5 with a dedicated GPU